

RSO Definition, Status, Privileges and Registration



RSO Definition

A Recognized Student Organization is an entity created by the students, for the students, with the purpose of gathering around a shared interest and/or topic, and has completed the process and met all requirements as set forth by the Office of Student Activities.

A Recognized Student Organization must adhere to the following principles:

1. Initial recruitment of the organization must be available to all students
2. Membership to the organization cannot require enrollment in an associated class
3. Membership cannot require employment
4. Membership must be by choice, without the incentive of scholarship or pay
5. Majority of membership must be students currently enrolled at the University of Central Missouri

RSO Categories

- Academic
 - Organizations tied to an academic program
- Departmental
 - Organization tied to a department on campus
- Community Service
 - Organizations committed to serving non-profits and the community
- Culture & Identity
 - Organizations that represent and celebrate culture and heritage
- Club Sports
 - Organizations engaged in intercollegiate competition
- Recreational
 - Organizations dedicated to fitness or outdoor activities non-competitively
- Special Interest
 - Organizations dedicated to student passions that do not fall in previous categories.
- Social Greek
 - Organizations that are members of Interfraternity Council or Panhellenic Council
- NPHC
 - Organizations that are part of National Pan-Hellenic Council
- Religious
 - Organizations that are faith-based

RSO Recognition Privileges

All RSOs maintaining Active Status can benefit from the privileges listed below:

- The right to be recognized and represented on the UCM campus, on the Office of Student Activities' website, and on Central Connect
- With permission from Integrated Marketing and Communications - to use the University's copyrighted logo
- Access to University facilities (free or reduced charge) and assistance with activities of the organizations
- Ability to apply for funds from the Student Funding Committee each semester
- Operational budget funds for the academic year
- Ability to create a ucmo.edu email address
- Advisement and support through the Office of Student Activities
- Opportunity to sponsor fundraising events on campus and to participate in co-sponsorships with other organizations on campus
- Permission to use campus bulletin boards for advertising programs/events with prior approval by the Office of Student Activities
- To use a mailbox in the Office of Student Activities Office

RSO “Active” Status Requirement

For an organization to receive and keep being recognized as an “Active” Recognized Student Organization, one must maintain the following requirements. This information must be reflected on the organization’s Central Connect admin page.

- A current constitution
- At least 8 members
- At least two officer registered
- An employee of the college as the organization’s advisor
 - Employees count as professors, professional staff, and graduate assistants
 - Advisors can only advise **three** student organizations at any time
 - Student organizations must seek out advisors; the Office of Student Activities is not responsible for locating advisors on the organization’s behalf
- Completed the Central Connect transitioning request from the Office of Student Activities when required
- At least one officer and one advisor to attend required trainings

RSO “Non-Active” Statuses

Pending Student Organization

A pending student organization is a new organization which is in the process of becoming a Recognized Student Organization on campus. Pending student organizations are eligible for a variety of benefits including reserving rooms and posting information on bulletin boards.

RSO “Non-Active” Status Continued

Probationary Status

A student organization that fails to meet the active status requirements for one semester will be placed on probationary status until the requirements are met. Organizations on probation may not be eligible to reserve rooms, post information on bulletin boards, or receive funding from the Student Funding Committee. If an organization remains on probationary status for 1 year without communication with the Office of Student Activities, it will be non-recognized (Deactivated).

Deactivated Status

A student organization which is no longer recognized by the University. Deactivated organizations are not eligible for any benefits including use of campus space and Student Funding Committee funds. To reactivate an organization, one must follow the reactivation process.

Organizations may request the Office of Student Activities to deactivate their organization during the dissolution process, provided their constitution permits it.

Reactivation Process

Students can officially start the reactivation process by submitting a request to the Office of Student Activities at osa@ucmo.edu.

Once the request is submitted, the organization's previous Central Connect page will be reactivated, and the organization's representative will receive access and be required to update and manage the page.

Organizations may begin the reactivation process without all required information. However, if the organization fails to meet the necessary requirements and update its Central Connect page within 30 days of initiating reactivation, the process will be voided. To avoid this, organizations are encouraged to initiate the process with the required information obtained and update their Central Connect page promptly as soon as information becomes available.

During this 30-day period, the organization is allowed to post flyers on campus through the Office of Student Activities and participate in Involvement Fairs and Mule Walk, if these events are available.

Required Updates for Central Connect

- An updated constitution ([see this example](#))
- A list of at least 8 student members
- A minimum of 2 officers
- An employee of the college as the organization's advisor
 - Employees count as faculty, professional staff, and graduate assistants
 - Advisors can only advise three student organizations at any time
 - Student organizations must seek out advisors; the Office of Student Activities is not responsible for locating advisors on the organization's behalf

Organization Registration Process

A group shall apply to register in a manner prescribed by the Office of Student Activities. Registration must be completed within Central Connect.

Step 1: Collect the required organization information

Information required for registration includes:

- A constitution ([see this example](#)).
- A list of at least 8 student members and their ucmo.edu emails
- A current officer listing, at least two officers must be registered
- An employee of the college as the organization's advisor
 - Employees count as faculty, professional staff, and graduate assistants
 - Advisors can only advise **three** student organizations at any time
 - Student organizations must seek out advisors; the Office of Student Activities is not responsible for locating advisors on the organization's behalf

Step 2: Fill out the form

A student must submit the organization's information above by filling out the form that is available on [Central Connect](#). The form is located in the "Forms" tab in Central Connect. The office no longer accepts paper registration forms.

Step 3: Wait for the decision

Once a decision has been made, the student who filled out the form will be notified via email from the Central Connect system email. The decision process may take up to 2 weeks.

- The office may deny the application if any information is missing. If you received a denial mail from Central Connect, please refer to the reasons for denial cited within the email and resubmit the form with updated information.

Step 4: Accept Invitation

Once the registration is approved, an invitation email to join the organization will be sent to the student emails of those who are on the application form. They must accept the invitation to join the organization and information to be reflected on Central Connect.

Review of Organizations

- At the end of each semester and before the Student Funding Committee funding process, the Office of Student Activities shall review the status of all organizations to determine whether they meet all the requirements outlined in the RSO Handbook, to maintain active status.
- If an organization fails to meet the requirements, the Assistant Director of the Office of Student Activities may determine that the organization be removed from the list of “Active” Recognized Student Organizations, placed under “Probationary” or “Deactivated” status.

“Club Sports” Registration

Organizations that are defined as Club Sports follow a process similar to what is outline above, but also have specific considerations that apply to their application. Please thoroughly review the “**UCM Club Sports Definition & Regulations**” before submitting your registration.